

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 4, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 12:1–11

1 Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I do not want you to be ignorant:

2 You know that you were Gentiles, carried away to these dumb idols, however you were led.

3 Therefore I make known to you that no one speaking by the Spirit of God calls Jesus accursed, and no one can say that Jesus is Lord except by the Holy Spirit.

4 There are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit.

5 There are differences of ministries, but the same Lord.

6 And there are diversities of activities, but it is the same God who works all in all.

7 But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to each one for the profit of all:

8 for to one is given the word of wisdom through the Spirit, to another the word of knowledge through the same Spirit,

9 to another faith by the same Spirit, to another gifts of healings by the same Spirit,

10 to another the working of miracles, to another prophecy, to another discerning of spirits, to another different kinds of tongues, to another the interpretation of tongues.

11 But one and the same Spirit works all these things, distributing to each one individually as He wills.

II. Key Summary

- Paul reminds the Corinthians that they were once Gentiles led astray to worship silent idols, and they now need to understand what spiritual gifts actually are (vv. 1–2)
- Paul gives a clear test for discerning true spiritual experience: no one speaking by the Spirit of God will call Jesus accursed, and no one can say "Jesus is Lord" except by the

Holy Spirit (v. 3)

- Although gifts, ministries, and activities differ widely, they all come from the same Spirit; the Spirit gives manifestations to each person specifically for the benefit of everyone, distributing them as He wills (vv. 4–11)

III. Passage Analysis

The Test for True Spiritual Experience: Does It Glorify Jesus?

"Does a supposed spiritual gift glorify Jesus? Does it promote the true Jesus or a false one? The ministry of the Holy Spirit is not to promote Himself or any man, but to glorify and represent Jesus." [1]

Paul's contrast between idol worship and the Holy Spirit is sharp: idols are mute and passive, but the Holy Spirit is active and always points toward Jesus. When something claims to be spiritual, the real question isn't whether it feels powerful or emotional — it's whether it keeps the focus on Jesus rather than on the experience itself or the person involved.

Everyone Has Something; Nobody Has Everything

"Every one of us has something, and no one of us has everything; so, on the one hand, we want each other." [2]

Verse 7 says the Spirit's manifestation is given to each one "for the profit of all" — not for personal recognition or competition. The variety of gifts isn't a ranking system; it's a design feature. The church only works well when everyone brings what they have and relies on what others carry.

IV. Reflection Question

Think of something you're genuinely good at — a subject, a skill, something people often come to you for. Can you remember a specific moment when a classmate actually needed your help, but your first thought was "this is a good chance to show what I can do" rather than "what does this person actually need right now"? What did you end up doing?

If your starting point had shifted from "let them see my ability" to "let them actually be helped," do you think you would have made the same choice?

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-12/>

[2] BibleHub.com, MacLaren's Exposition on 1 Corinthians 12:7,

https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/12-7.htm